

review in this issue), because no one has time to play arcade racers "just for fun" when there's huge money at stake.

The game's single player mode is just plain crazy: it has 90 race tracks, and you can choose to be one of 60 countries. I chose India, of course, and thought I could help my country move up in the rankings (it was 44th when I last checked); I was wrong! Except for the Beginner mode, which is embarrassingly easy, the game is really hard to play. I found myself having to take 20 turns or more, on average, before I could complete the Advanced or Expert tracks.

Online

Since the game is light, I expected the Internet gaming experience to be a *little* better than most other games; I was wrong—the Internet experience is quite amazing! Fast local servers also make sure that you don't wait too long, and lag is non-existent. The game is tremendous fun over a LAN as well. Pity the maps don't have more descriptive names though, because it's really irritating to try and find that map you like: "Was it G-1 or I-1? Maybe it was H-7?"

Track Mania...

...is what the level and map developers were thinking when they designed these levels—the tracks have the most amazing hurdles, but this also makes it a nightmare to play: loop-de-loops, spins, jumps and crashes. What else could you want?

Drive-Throughs

One thing that will seem weird is the whole "you can drive through your opponents" thing. Yes, race with people and you can't fight with them, *Need For Speed* style! It's like racing ghosts; you compete with the track, not with your opponents!

Customising

For a full free game, the level of customisation is OK - but it's not even remotely as cool as the *Need For Speed* series, and you can't change your cars or your engines—or anything except the colour of your ride, actually. But like I said, since it's a free game and is light on resources, I'm pretty happy.

Anyway, enough with this review; I'll take your leave by giving it an 8/10. Take a look at the screenshots to better understand what the game is like. Or better still, put down this magazine, pop in the DVD, install it and see for yourself. Remember, it is your duty as an Indian citizen to try and get us a little higher in the country rankings, so best of luck, and *Jai Hind!* ■

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